

theatre

Staging a Story

MUMBAI/BANGALORE

Contact Theatre, based in Manchester in the UK, selected 12 theatre companies from across the world—from Palestine and Zambia to New York and Poland—earlier this year to perform at the Contacting the World Festival to be held in Liverpool in July. The international theatre exchange project requires each company to premiere an original work at the festival. Evam Youth Forum, the company that will represent India, will stage its play in 15 different shows in Mumbai and Bangalore before embarking on the European sojourn.

Titled *Hair*, the performance is written and directed by Ajay Krishnan and devised and performed by a group of young, talented actors. This play marks a definite deviation from Krishnan's earlier works and promises to take the audience into the darker realm of the fairytale world. Instead of bubbles and confetti, there are

stories, events and episodes the audience is not used to seeing onstage.

Hair delves into the immortal story of Rapunzel—the baby, who, imprisoned in a tower by a spiteful witch, grows up to become a beautiful girl with long, flowing hair. Soon enough, a handsome prince comes along to rescue her and make her his own. Evam Youth Forum, whose work is to a large extent influenced by visual theatre, not only recreates the fairytale but injects life into the characters that are mere names to us. What did they say? How did they behave? What was the relationship the hero and heroine shared? And most importantly, what was their motivation? The play attempts to explore this unseen world through music, emotion and movement to discover that 'happily ever after' is never as simple as it sounds. In Mumbai from June 6-8 at NCPA Experimental and from June 10-15 at Prithvi Theatre. In Bangalore from June 20-22 at Ranga Shankara. In Liverpool, UK, from July 27-August 4.

by **Nirmala Ravindran**

FAIRYTALE MOMENT: The Forum is influenced by visual theatre



festival

The Tapestry of Tradition

KOHIMA SPIC-XM's endeavour to introduce Indian music, dance and culture to students continues in full throttle even 35 years after its inception, with its national convention scheduled to be held in Kohima from June 15-21. There will be interactions with maestros of classical music and dance as well as leading folk artistes, screenings of films by Satyajit Ray and Akira Kurosawa, craft workshops, yoga sessions and heritage walks. Flautist Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia, dhruwad maestro Ustad R. Fahiruddin Dagar, violinist T.N. Krishnan and rudra veena artiste Ustad Asad Ali Khan will perform. There will be demonstrations by noted painter Anjolie Ela Menon and puppeteer Dadi Pudumjee. Delegates can participate in workshops under vocalist Ustad Abdul Rashid Khan, Manipuri dancer Suryamukhi Devi and Kalamkari artist J. Gurappa Chetty, among others.

by **S. Sahaya Ranjit**

GOLDEN STRINGS:

Ustad Asad Ali Khan



art

In Her Element

MUMBAI Inspired by the philosophy of *panchtatva*, the five infinite elements, Madhuri Kathe's work is a collection of pure abstracts. As no one colour defines an element, the choice of hues expresses the artist's feelings. In her collection of 35 mixed media pieces, titled 'Path of Liberation', Kathe, who feels spirituality is



Kathe's work

intangible, has made use of dressing mesh to show sensitivity through texture. At Jehangir Art Gallery from June 2-8.

by **Swati Mathur**